

NATIONAL LOUIS UNIVERSITY
Informed Consent to Participate in Research
Pedagogical Friction in the Age of Generative AI and Tertiary
Algorithmicity

Anonymous online survey — displayed as the first screen of the survey

Study period: 09-2026 to 02-2027

Review copy. The survey remains closed until written NLU IRB approval.

Who is doing this study

My name is Micah J. Miner, and I am a doctoral candidate in the Curriculum, Advocacy, and Policy program at National Louis University. I am asking you to participate in this study, “Pedagogical Friction in the Age of Generative AI and Tertiary Algorithmicity,” occurring from 09-2026 to 02-2027. I am conducting this study as part of my dissertation under the supervision of Dr. Terri Jo Smith. I also work as a school district technology administrator in Illinois. That role is separate from this study, and this study is not conducted on behalf of any school district, company, or product.

Why this study is being done

This survey asks K–12 educators and school system leaders how generative AI is affecting the effortful parts of learning in their schools, and what policy, assessment, professional learning, and leadership conditions help or hinder their response. The goal is to help school systems write AI guidance grounded in reported practice.

Who can take part

You may take part if you are 18 years of age or older and you currently work in a K–12 school or district as a classroom-facing educator, a building administrator, or a district or system leader. Employees of Beach Park Community Consolidated School District 3 are not eligible for this study. You are also not eligible if the researcher holds supervisory or evaluative authority over you or if you and the researcher currently have or are discussing a consulting, contracting, or paid speaking arrangement.

What you will be asked to do

You will complete one online survey, one time only, taking about 10 to 12 minutes. Most questions are rating scales. A few ask you to answer in your own words. Some questions are shown only to certain roles, so your survey may be shorter than the full item list. There is no interview or follow-up unless you independently choose to open a separate, unlinked interest form after submitting the survey. That form collects only your email address for scheduling and cannot be connected to your survey responses.

Risks and benefits

The risk to you is no greater than that of everyday life. Because the survey is anonymous, the risk of disclosure is low. There is no guaranteed direct benefit to you. The broader benefit is better-grounded AI guidance for schools.

How your information will be kept confidential

This survey is administered in Microsoft Forms. It will not ask for your name or email address and will not require you to sign in. Before the survey opens, the researcher will verify and document the final Microsoft Forms settings relevant to response anonymity and metadata. The researcher will not be able to connect your identity to your responses.

Please do not type the names of students, colleagues, schools, or districts into the open-response boxes. If any such name appears, I will remove it before analysis.

Responses are exported from the survey platform and stored in encrypted, access-controlled storage in my NLU-managed OneDrive account. I am the only person with routine access. Aggregated results and de-identified quotations from open responses may appear in the dissertation and in publications and presentations that follow. Data are kept for at least three years after the study closes.

Because the survey is anonymous, I cannot locate and delete your individual responses once you submit them. If you want to withdraw, close the survey before you submit.

Your participation is voluntary

Taking part is entirely your choice. You may skip any question, and you may close the survey at any point before submitting. You will not be paid. Declining or withdrawing will not affect your employment, your standing in any professional organization, or your relationship with the researcher.

Sharing the results

When the study is finished, I will send a short plain-language summary of the findings to any participant who asks for one. The completed dissertation will be available through National Louis University, and I will provide a link on request.

Whom to contact

If you have questions about this study, contact the researcher:

Micah J. Miner, doctoral candidate, National College of Education, National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL 60603. Email: mminer1@my.nl.edu. Phone: 312-504-4193.

You may also contact the faculty member supervising this study:

Dr. Terri Jo Smith, Committee Chair, National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL 60603. Email: TJSmith@nl.edu. Phone: 224-233-2315.

If you have any concerns or questions before or during participation that have not been addressed by the researcher, you may contact the Chairs of National Louis University's Institutional Research Board:

Dr. Shaunti Knauth; email: Shaunti.Knauth@nl.edu; phone: (312) 261-3526; or Dr. Carla L. Sparks; email: CSparks3@nl.edu; phone: (813) 928-6889. IRB Chairs are located at National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL.

Statement of consent

Please print or save a copy of this page for your records. A printable copy is linked at the top of the survey.

ELECTRONIC CONSENT: Please select your choice below. You may print a copy of this consent form for your records. Clicking on the "Agree" button indicates that

You have read the above information

You voluntarily agree to participate

You are 18 years of age or older

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree